SYNTHETIC SUPPLIER RESPONSE

Apex Systems

Procurement Evaluation Workspace | RFP CVPSC-RFP-2026-014

Issuing entity	Cedar Valley Public Services Consortium
Response date	October 20, 2026
Offer validity	90 days unless noted in pricing assumptions
Bid position	Strong technical architecture and security; premium price; moderate 18-week delivery.

1. Executive Summary

Apex Systems proposes a secure, configurable procurement workspace that combines document intake, evidence-linked AI assistance, human review, and deterministic Python scoring. The design is technically detailed and security-forward. The bid is the highest priced of the four and allows a measured 18-week implementation.

Understanding of the requirement

- CVPSC needs a single auditable workspace for supplier submissions, configurable evaluation criteria, and reviewer decisions.
- AI may organize proposal evidence, but weighted scores and supplier rankings must remain reproducible application logic.
- Users need role-based access, exportable run records, and clear handling of scanned or incomplete PDFs.

2. Proposed Solution

- Apex proposes a tenant-isolated web application with a Streamlit reviewer console, Python service layer, and managed PostgreSQL production store; a SQLite-compatible local demonstration mode is included.
- PDF text is extracted page by page. An LLM returns schema-constrained criterion assessments with cited proposal evidence; reviewers can inspect each excerpt before deterministic scoring.
- The design includes immutable evaluation-run snapshots, configurable criteria, JSON export, and audit events for changes to criteria and reviewer decisions.

Integration position: Apex identifies SAML/OIDC single sign-on and an outbound document archive as integration targets. Detailed API field mappings are scheduled for discovery in week 2.

3. Implementation Approach

The following work plan is a supplier estimate for the shared RFP scope. Milestones require CVPSC product-owner review and written acceptance.

Phase	Milestone and deliverable	Target
1. Discovery and architecture	Confirm workflows, roles, hosting region, data classification	Weeks 1-3
2. Core workspace	Criteria, supplier intake, PDF processing, audit model	Weeks 4-8
3. Evaluation and assurance	Evidence review, deterministic scores, security testing	Weeks 9-14
4. Pilot and handover	UAT, migration rehearsal, training, production release	Weeks 15-18

Timeline and acceptance gates

Gate	Evidence required for acceptance
Design sign-off	Requirements traceability, role map, and integration assumptions approved.
Build complete	Core flows demonstrated with synthetic supplier proposals.
Pilot exit	Security and UAT issues dispositioned; results reviewed by CVPSC.
Go-live	Support owner accepts runbooks, recovery plan, and escalation path.

Proposed team structure

Role	Named lead	Allocation and responsibility
Delivery lead	A. Chen	0.6 FTE; weekly plan and decisions
Solution architect	M. Okafor	0.5 FTE; architecture and integrations
Security engineer	R. Singh	0.4 FTE; threat model and controls
Application team	4 engineers + QA	Build, test, and pilot support

4. Price and Commercial Assumptions

Price component	Amount	Basis
Discovery and fixed implementation	$620,000	One time
Managed hosting and support	$148,000	Per year
Three-year evaluated total	$1,064,000	Implementation + 3 annual terms

- USD, exclusive of applicable taxes; proposal valid for 90 days.
- Includes two production environments, 30 named users, and 1 TB document storage.
- External identity-provider fees, OCR for image-only archives, and custom integrations beyond SSO/archive are excluded.

5. Security, Compliance, and Risk Controls

- TLS 1.2+ in transit, AES-256 at rest, managed key rotation, tenant-scoped authorization, and least-privilege administrative roles.
- Proposed controls map to SOC 2 and NIST CSF practices; an independent SOC 2 report is not attached to this sample bid.
- Daily encrypted backups, 90-day audit retention, annual penetration testing, and a 24-hour critical-incident notification target.

Risk	Proposed control or open action
Identity-provider decisions arrive after week 3	Could move SSO testing; confirm protocol and test tenant during discovery.
Large scanned archives exceed allowance	OCR is excluded; sample archive volume before signing and price the option.

6. Support, Experience, and References

- 24x7 P1 intake with a 30-minute acknowledgement target; business-hours P2/P3 support.
- Named customer success engineer, monthly service report, quarterly recovery exercise, and 40 hours of administrator training.

Apex states that it has delivered three public-sector workflow platforms. The sample bid includes a reference matrix and architecture overview, but no customer artifacts or independently verifiable credentials.

Fictional reference	Relevant work	Availability
Pine County Services (fictional)	Workflow portal	Contact available with permission
Lakeview Transit Cooperative (fictional)	Document intake	Reference window: 2024-2025

Evidence quality: Strongest evidence in this set for architecture and stated security controls; certifications and test reports are described but not attached.

Open items and missing information

- Confirm production hosting region and data-residency commitment.
- Attach current SOC 2 report or equivalent independent assurance evidence.
- Confirm retention/deletion period for prompts and model-provider logs.